



Winding ascent: The bus winds its way up the forested roads to the Aichi Prefectural General Shooting Gallery. Mountain village: A quiet mountain village with traditional Japanese houses along the route to the Aichi Prefectural General Shooting Gallery near Toyota. PICS: JONATHAN SELVARAJ

the range,” sighs Manu Ravi, husband of Vidarsa, who was part of the Indian women’s 10m air rifle team that won a silver. “I am staying in Nagoya city so first I have to get to Nagoya Metro station, take a train to Fushimi, then take another metro to Akaike, then take another train to Toyotashi. From there I have to take another bus to Onuma. That’s another 30 stops away,” he says.

But his journey isn’t done just yet. There’s another 12km to cover, and his only option is to take a taxi. “It cost me 7000 rupees but it was worth it because I got to see Vidarsa win a medal in person and not on TV!” he says.

Electricity conservation

The Aichi Prefectural General Shooting Gallery is stunning. Originally built in 1993, it was renovated ahead of the Asian Games. It’s being used for these Asian Games because it is one of Japan’s largest

comprehensive shooting facilities, with rifle, pistol and shotgun ranges on the same premises. What it apparently lacks, though, high up in the mountains, is a strong enough supply of electricity. Media persons were told to limit the number of devices they kept on charge in order not to overload the system. It also means that the electric kettle normally used to brew the endless cups of coffee that keep you going through a multi-event Games is missing. If you need hot water, it’s rationed out a cup at a time by a volunteer.

No sign no problem

The Aichi-Nagoya Games have got a massive rap for accommodation issues faced by players, with officials sticking by the rules even when it’s clear

that they aren’t working. Just ahead of the women’s 10m final, this journalist found himself a seat in a section that had a sign that mentioned it was for media persons, spectators and athletes. However, he was told by a volunteer that he needed to move since the section was only for spectators. The volunteer was triumphantly shown the signboard, which clearly said that media was allowed in the designated section. In response, the volunteer calmly picked up the sign, took it away and told this defeated journalist that this was indeed only a spectator area.

